

SOME PROMINENT ACQUISITIONS

Year	Target	Product category	Markets served	Deal size (₹ crore)
● 2003	Glucovita	Glucose powder	India	5
● 2004	Chandrika	Bathing soap	India	30
● 2006	North-West Switchgear	Switches	India	102
● 2007	Unza Holdings	Personal care and skincare	Southeast Asia and China	1,010
● 2009	Yardley	Fragrance, bath and shower, skincare	Asia, Middle East, Australasia, parts of Africa	210
● 2012	LD Waxsons Group	Skincare products	Malaysia, Singapore and China	785
● 2016	Zhongshan Ma Er Daily Products	Personal care	China	N/A
● 2022	Nirapara	Packaged rice powder and spices	India	N/A
● 2023	Brahmins	Pre-mix powders, spices, pickles	India	N/A

SOURCE COMPANY ANNOUNCEMENTS, MEDIA REPORTS

| 71

advantage over rival lighting brands. “I sell my products in grocery stores, which is 25 per cent of my business, but the competition sells only in electrical outlets.” India has 10 million grocery stores and 50,000-odd electrical outlets. Agrawal says Wipro sells bulbs in the grocery stores it reaches because the typical housewife buys bulbs. For compact fluorescent lamps or CFLs, Wipro sells to the shopkeeper and “not through him”. The shopkeeper is the “influencer”. Ditto for LED bulbs.

Electrical stores are only about undercutting. Also, a grocer does not ask for credit, but electrical outlets get 21 days. “It just makes our model a lot more sustainable, and that’s why we got into lighting,” says Agrawal.

Gaurav Dua, Head-Capital Market Strategy at Sharekhan by BNP Paribas, a retail equity brokerage, says Wipro Enterprises could demerge the lighting business into a separate entity just as parent Wipro Ltd had spun off the consumer business.



WHILE DRAWING UP the strategy in November 2006, Wipro Consumer had already made a couple of buy-outs (all in the domestic market), though they were small. The first was Glucovita from HLL in 2003, followed by Chandrika soaps a year later. Azim Premji told the sellers he “wanted to buy Chandrika because he liked the soap”. During the bidding game, Agrawal recalls writing to Premji to tell him the outgo could be marginally higher. Premji told him: “Don’t waste my time. Just get the deal.”

“At that point, FMCG companies were looking outside India at smaller markets such as Bangladesh,”